KARSTATION

Email Sending Ethics Guide

Simple rules for what to use, what to check, and how to set an away notice

What to use

- **Your official KARSTATION email address** for all work email. Do not use a personal Gmail or Yahoo account for company business.
- **The standard KARSTATION signature** from the generator, so every email looks the same. Do not remove the confidentiality notice.
- **A clear subject line** that says what the email is about, for example "Invoice 1042: approval needed by Friday".
- **Plain, readable writing**: short paragraphs, normal fonts, no all-capital words.
- **Bcc** when you email a group of outside people, so their addresses stay private.

Before you press Send

Do	Do not
+ Check every name in To and Cc	- Use Reply All unless everyone needs the answer
+ Attach the right file and open it once	- Send passwords, card numbers or ID numbers by email
+ Be polite, even when the topic is hard	- Forward private emails without asking first
+ Reply within one working day, or say when you will	- Open attachments or links you did not expect
+ Report strange emails or links to your manager	- Send angry emails. Wait, then reread

Away notices (out of office)

Set an away notice whenever you will not read email for a working day or more: leave, travel, training or time off duty.

- **Set it before you leave** and give it an end date, so it turns off by itself.
- **Include**: the dates you are away, the date you are back, and who to contact (name and official email).
- **Keep it short.** Do not give personal reasons, travel plans or your home address.
- **Do not promise** a reply time you cannot keep.

Sample away message

Subject: Out of office until 24 November

Thank you for your email. I am away from the office from 17 to 21 November and will reply when I return on 24 November. For urgent matters please contact [Colleague name] at [colleague official email].

Kind regards,
[Your name]

How to switch it on

Your email app	Where to find it
New Outlook / Outlook on the web	Settings (gear) > Accounts > Automatic replies in new Outlook, or Settings > Mail > Automatic replies on the web. Turn it on and set the dates.
Classic Outlook	File > Automatic Replies. Choose **Send automatic replies** and tick the time range.
Webmail, or any account that uses POP or IMAP	Sign in to cPanel and open **Email > Autoresponders > Add Autoresponder**. Fill in Interval (24 hours is a good choice), Email, From, Subject and Body. Under Start and Stop choose **Custom** and set your dates. You can have one autoresponder per email address.
Thunderbird	Thunderbird has no built-in away notice, so set it on the server using the cPanel steps above.

> **When you are back**
> Check that the notice has stopped. If you did not set an end date, turn it off yourself on your first day back.